

MAPLEWOOD HOME & LIVING

Internal Memo – Refunds, Payments & Discounts

Last updated: March 2026 (supersedes the Jan 2024 version, please discard old copies)

Hi team,

After last quarter's mess with the chargebacks we sat down with accounting and tidied up our refund rules. Please read this carefully, it applies to everyone on the support desk INCLUDING the new AI assistant we are piloting.

Refunds

Support staff and the assistant can issue refunds up to \$100 without asking anyone. Anything above \$100 needs sign-off from a shift manager before the money goes out. If a refund is above \$500 it must go to Priya (Finance Director) personally – no exceptions, even for regulars.

Refunds are only allowed within 30 days of the original purchase. After 30 days we offer store credit instead, same approval limits apply. We do NOT refund gift card purchases in cash, ever. Store credit only.

If a customer paid in cash, refunds over \$50 must be processed as a bank transfer, not from the till.

Partial refunds for bundles (e.g. the 3-piece patio set): if a customer keeps part of a bundle, refund the returned items pro-rata minus the 15% restocking fee. The assistant should never calculate this on its own for bundles worth more than \$300 – escalate to a human.

Payments & Discounts

Nobody on the desk (human or otherwise) may apply a discount larger than 20% to any item. Seasonal promos come from marketing with a promo code – if there is no code in the system, there is no discount, I don't care what the customer says Groupon told them.

Price matching: we don't do it. Politely decline.

Never split a single purchase across more than two cards. It breaks the POS reconciliation and Devi will hunt you down.

Any refund issued to a card different from the original payment card needs manager approval regardless of the amount.

Thanks all,
Marcus
Operations Lead